

LIVE

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ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

11th WEEK



INDIA-FRANCE ... MULTI POLAR WORLD

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... Bilateral Groupings and Agreements involving India and/or affecting India's Interests.

2

Indo-French harmony

PM Modi and President Macron deepen ties to work around global uncertainties

Much like the pioneering India-France strategic partnership of 1998, the agreements signed during President Emmanuel Macron's visit are set to strengthen bilateral cooperation at a time of global flux. The Joint Vision Statement on the Indian Ocean Region is clearly aimed at countering China's growing presence in the region. And the International Solar Alliance, recommitment to starting the Jaitapur nuclear power plant, and joint ventures on climate change cooperation are reactions to the U.S. abdicating its role by announcing its pullout from the Paris accord. The "reciprocal logistics support" agreement, which Prime Minister Narendra Modi called a "golden step" in defence cooperation, is a signal to Russia and to the U.S. that both New Delhi and Paris feel the need to diversify strategic postures beyond their current choices. Finally, by bringing 61 countries into the ISA, India and France are proposing an alternative leadership model for the less developed world, challenging the geopolitical power structure configured around fossil-fuel energy resources. Notably, Mr. Modi and Mr. Macron declared they would ensure cheaper solar energy and increase avenues for financing, something that has created heat at the WTO. The daunting task ahead is made clear by Mr. Macron's assertion that \$1 trillion is needed to reach the ISA goals by 2030: India and France have so far committed \$1.4 billion and \$1.3 billion, respectively.

There are other contradictions that New Delhi and Paris must contend with. For example, India's solar power tariffs stand at about ₹2-40 a unit and there is little scope to make the domestic industry profitable, as Mr. Modi wants, unless the cost of solar panels and other components are brought down drastically. At the same time, more thermal power, for which tariffs are higher but which is less fickle than solar or wind power, is being produced than the demand. France's nuclear power story is a success, but negotiations between EDF and NPCIL for the Jaitapur plant, billed as the world's biggest, have made very slow progress. While the two countries have committed to start construction by end-2018, they have missed deadlines multiple times. Bilateral cooperation in the Indian Ocean Region too is more symbolic than substantive today, and much will depend on how closely the Indian and French navies and intelligence work together in the future. The presumed joint message to Beijing may also be blurred by Mr. Macron's parallel commitment to help "lead" the Belt and Road Initiative with China. As two pluralistic democracies with a firm belief in a multipolar world order and in the future of Eurasia, India and France have numerous strategic convergences. But common ambitions to cooperate on the world stage, as projected by Mr. Macron and Mr. Modi, must be grounded in some hard realities as well.

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IMPORTANT QUESTION**ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS**

The visit of the France President signals an era of multi-polar world order.
Critically examine.



NEWS REPORT



- 1 India and France joined hands in ensuring Freedom of Navigation in the Indo-Pacific region.
- 2 It stated that India and France share common concerns on Freedom of Navigation in the region and will tackle challenges to overflight.
- 3 Both the countries released Joint Strategic Vision for cooperation in the Indian Ocean Region.
- 4 There is also vast scope stretching from countering maritime terrorism and piracy to building maritime domain awareness.

This is the second major maritime initiative involving India during the last six months following the quadrilateral arrangement with Australia, Japan and US in Oct, 2017.



CHINA

Myanmar
(Burma)

VIETNAM

LAOS

THAILAND

CAMBODIA

Gulf of
Thailand

MALAYSIA

MALAYSIA

Paracel
Islands

Scarborough
Shoal

South China Sea

Spratly
Islands

PHILIPPINES

Philippine S

PREVIOUS NEWS ITEM

Reliance Aero structure Limited has made Joint Venture with Dassault Aviation to undertake major share of offset business arising from defence deal between India and France for Rafale fighter jets.



SALIENT POINTS

- In Sep, 2016, India signed a purchase agreement for 36 Rafale fighter jets for € 7.87 bn.
- The contract includes 50% offset clause i.e. Rs. 30,000 cr, the largest ever offset contract in India.

The deal incorporated 50 per cent offset clause, ensuring that 50 per cent of the deal's amount will be invested in the Indian defence ecosystem.

PREVIOUS
NEWS ITEM

DEFENCE EQUIPMENT & COUNTRIES

- Amphibious US-2 ... Japan
- Howitzer M777 ... USA
- Poseidon 8I ... USA
- Chinook ... USA
- Apache ... USA
- Kamov Ka-226T ... Russia
- S-400 Triumf ... Russia
- Nuclear Submarine, INS Chakra ... Russia
- Rafale Fighter Jets ... France
- Dassault Mirage 2000 ... France
- Kalashnikov Weapons ... Israel

PREVIOUS NEWS ITEM

The Prime Minister dedicated to the Nation INS Kalvari. This is the first of the six Scorpene class submarines built under project 75 (Kalvari class) into the Indian Navy.



NAVAL
GROUP

SALIENT POINTS

- It is a diesel electric attack submarine built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited.
- It is the first of six such submarines that will be inducted into the navy.
- INS Kalvari will have anti-ship missiles and long range guided torpedoes and modern sensors to help enable it to seek out the enemy from long ranges.

It was started at Mazagon Docks Limited on 14th December 2006. The submarine's motto is "Ever Onward".

PREVIOUS NEWS ITEM

UNCLOS - 1982

**TERRITORIAL
WATERS
(UPTO 12 NM)**

Oceans and Law of the Sea
Division for Ocean Affairs and the Law of the Sea

**EXCLUSIVE
ECONOMIC ZONE
(UPTO 200 NM)**

- 12 NM from baseline.
- Free to set own laws by the countries.
- Ships will be given "Innocent Passage".
- The state will have sovereignty over these waters.

- Coastal state has sole exploitation rights over all the natural resources.
- Foreign nations have the freedom of Navigation and Overflight.
- Foreign states can lay submarine pipes and cables.

NAUTICAL MILE

1 Nautical mile = 1.852 kms. It is based on the circumference of the Earth and is equal to the length of the one minute of the longitude at the Equator.



MORE ON THE VISIT OF THE FRANCE PRESIDENT TO INDIA

- 1 The two sides agreed a new protocol for the exchange of classified information between the two sides.
- 2 Both the sides also agreed for early conclusion of the discussions between DRDO and French firm Safran for combat engines for indigenous Tejas fighters.
- 3 If M88 engines of Safran are to be produced in India with full transfer of technology that might solve our concerns regarding the Tejas programme.
- 4 India and France agreed to treat each other's academic degrees as equivalent for higher studies and jobs, the first such initiative to facilitate the mobility of students between the two countries.

Reciprocal logistics between armed forces will facilitate the French and Indian armed forces to receive logistical support, supplies and services from each other during authorised port visits, joint exercises, joint training, humanitarian assistance and disaster relief efforts.

HOW TO VIEW THESE DEVELOPMENTS?

1 In view of 20th anniversary of strategic partnership, India and France stepped up their engagement by concluding reciprocal logistics between armed forces.

2 It does not suffer from political sensitivities, the way LEMOA suffered with US.

3 The message to the outside world is, India is not limiting itself to quadrilateral to develop interests in the Indo-Pacific.

4 Joint Strategic Vision in Indian Ocean Region is a clear message to China to maintain the safety of international sea lanes.

5 The relationship seems to be an alternative to both US and Russia, when it comes to military hardware, aircraft, space cooperation and nuclear reactors.

As per the statement of Emmanuel Macron, France wants India as its first strategic partner in the region and also France want to be India's first strategic partner in Europe.

WHAT ABOUT CONTRADICTIONS?



- 1** China's Belt & Road Initiative strongly opposed by India but, France is likely to play a leading role in it.
- 2** There is re-affirmation of commitment to 9.6 GW nuclear power plant at Jaitapur in Maharashtra. But, whether it will take-off is the million dollar question. India wants a price for the reactors, that will make the power not costlier than Rs. 6.5 per hour, while France's Areva (EDF) wants more.
- 3** In Rafale deal, France is pushing to get India to buy 36 more fighter jets.

HOW TO VIEW THE VISIT OF THE FRANCE PRESIDENT?

- 1** International Solar Alliance, Commitment of starting Jaitapur nuclear power plant, Joint ventures on climate change cooperation can be viewed as reactions to US, abdicating its role by announcing its pull-out from Paris accord.
- 2** Reciprocal logistics support agreement is a signal to both Russia and US that both New Delhi and Paris feel the need to diversify strategic postures.
- 3** By bringing 61 countries into ISA, India and France are proposing an alternative leadership model for the less developed world.
- 4** It also challenges the geo-political power structure configured around fossil fuel energy sources.

It signals, there is multipolar world order, the two pluralistic democracies can go ahead. Moreover, the countries have numerous strategic convergences.

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SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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